HARVARD T.H. CHAN
SCHOOL OF PUBLIC HEALTH

HEALTH SYSTEMS
INNOVATION LAB

Hackathon

Building High Value Health Systems: Leveraging AI

7th Edition

April 10-11, 2026

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Rubric

Grading Component	0 points	1 Point	2 Points
1 Problem Definition & Solution Framing	Not well defined	Defined, but not well measured or framed	Defined, measured, and framed effectively
2. Value Proposition & Innovation	Not novel or unclear	Some innovation, but unclear or weak value proposition	Clearly innovative solution with a compelling and unique value proposition
3. Opportunity	No clear market or user segment	Market identified, but no attempt to validate	Clearly defined target market with evidence of need or attempt to validate
4. Competitive Landscape	No awareness of competition	Acknowledges competition but limited differentiation	Clear understanding of competition with strong positioning and differentiation
5. Business Model	No viable model articulated	Business model described, but lacks detail or feasibility	Clear, viable, and potentially scalable business model
6. Go-to-Market (GTM) Strategy	No clear plan to reach users / customers / regulators / beneficiaries	Plan outlines but lacks depth or specificity	Clear, actionable GTM strategy targeted to value proposition, business model, and strategic positioning
7. Ask	No ask outlined	Non-specific understanding of funding needs, milestones and terms	Compelling understanding of funding needs, milestones / value inflection points, and terms
8. Team	No relevant expertise or unclear roles	Partial alignment of skills and roles	Strong team with complementary skills and clarity about roles
9. Presentation	Disorganized or unclear	Mostly clear but with gaps in communicating key ideas	Clear, confident, and compelling presentation
10. Q&A	Unable to answer questions effectively	Some responses vague or inconsistent	Answers questions, compelling response
Total			20

Pitch format: 8 minutes per team (3 minutes pitch + 5 minutes Q&A)

Remember the 8 Critical Elements to the Slide Deck

- Slide 1 = problem
  - What is the problem
- Slide 2 = Solution & value proposition
  - How does the product create user value
  - Solution and core components
- Slide 3 = Opportunity
  - What is the size of the market?
- Slide 4 = Competition
  - Who are the rivals and why innovation better
- Slide 5 = business model
  - How will you generate revenue?
- Slide 6 = Go-to-Market Strategy
  - How will you sell to customers and retain
- Slide 7 = Ask
  - Funding needed, applications, milestones achieved, terms
- Slide 8 = Team
  - Collective capabilities

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Pitching Tips

Tailor your pitch to investor

- Focus on impact and potential value

Capture attention early

- You have 30 seconds to hook your audience

Be concise and direct

- Avoid technical details
- Focus on problem ⟶ solution ⟶ impact

Anticipate Questions

Be ready to explain:

- Why this solution is better than current practice or existing options
- Who will use it and who will pay for it

Don't be 100% accurate and only 50% clear. Aim for 80% accurate and 100% clear. (YCombinator)